Gaucho Rocket Project
Member Handbook & Requirements

Last Updated October 13th, 2026

Overview

Gaucho Rocket Project (GRP) is UCSB's premier collegiate rocketry organization, dedicated to designing, building, and launching liquid-propellant rockets at the cutting edge of student rocketry. With a culture of engineering excellence and a relentless drive to push boundaries, GRP is striving to become the best collegiate group in the nation, including non-engineering groups. Our primary fabrication and development work takes place at the Santa Barbara Hackerspace (SBHX), where members work hands-on with rocket systems in a collaborative, well-equipped environment.

Our team is composed of passionate students from disciplines across the university, including the traditional engineering majors but also majors like Marine Science, Chemistry, and Economics. We are united by a shared mission to achieve technical mastery in rocketry. GRP continuously raises the bar for what student-led teams can accomplish.

Membership in GRP is a commitment to that mission. Every member contributes to a team culture built on safety, accountability, collaboration, and innovation. In return, members gain hands-on engineering experience, mentorship, and the opportunity to work on one of the most ambitious student rocketry programs in the country.

Member Requirements

All members of the Gaucho Rocket Project are required to complete the following certifications and training before participating in any hands-on project work, lab activities, or launch operations. These requirements are non-negotiable and exist to ensure the safety of every member and the integrity of our program.

1 Joining Our Team

To join Gaucho Rocket Project and obtain Active Member Status, complete the following:

1.1. Read and Sign the GRP Member Handbook & Requirements (This Document)

1.2. Submit an application for Gaucho Rocket Project — Link
Note: Please continue with the subsequent steps after submission

1.3. Read and sign the Santa Barbara HackerSpace Liability Form — Link

1.4. Read and sign the Friends of Amateur Rocketry (FAR) Liability Form — Link
Note: Leave Date field empty for the FAR Liability Form

1.5. Read the Shared Drive Usage Guide — Link

1.6. Get a Professional Headshot at UCSB Career Services — Link

1.7. Make and Upload a Resume with Latex/Overleaf Formatting — Template

1.8. Make a Linkedin Account and Follow the GRP Page— GRP Page – Example

1.9. Attend Two consecutive Gaucho Rocket Project General Body Meetings — Tuesdays at 6pm in Engineering II Room 1519

1.10. Safety Trainings — See Section 1.2

1.0.1 Submitting Documents

Once completed upload each document in this google drive folder Link. Make a new folder with your First and Last name as the tile.

Name Each Document as Follows

1. YMD_FirstName-LastName-DocumentAbbreviation_Folder_Version

Examples:

1. 20260816_Eddie-Barajas-MHR_EddieBarajas_v1
2. 20261223_Eddie-Barajas-RSQ_EddieBarajas_v1
3. 20260416_Eddie-Barajas-UCFLS_EddieBarajas_v1
4. 20260422_Eddie-Barajas-SBHZLF_EddieBarajas_v1
5. 20260116_Eddie-Barajas-FARLF_EddieBarajas_v1

1.0.2 Finalizing Active Member Status

Once the Above is completed we now have your information to sign you up for the Fundamentals of Lab Safety Training. You must complete both safety trainings to begin working in our lab spaces

1. Attend GRP's In-Person Rocketry Safety Class (See GRP Official Calendar) — Link
2. Complete and pass GRP's Rocketry Safety Quiz (Taken with the Safety Class)
3. Complete and certify the UC Fundamentals of Lab Safety Training (Online)

2 Active Member Status (AMS)

To maintain Active Member Status, members must:

2.1. Attend all General Body Meetings

2.1.1. Missing two consecutive meetings (unexcused) or missing 1/3 of a quarter's meetings will revoke AMS. Excused Absenses can be granted by Cheif Engineers under special circumstances.

2.2. Attend and complete quarterly in-person safety training

2.3. Attend at least ONE launch per quarter

2.1 Benefits of Active Member Status

AMS is what unlocks full participation in GRP. Active members retain:

- **SBHX Lab & Shop Access** — badge/key access to build and work on hardware
- **Launch Attendance** — eligibility to attend FAR launches in an operational or crew capacity
- **Voting Rights** — a voice in club elections and major decisions
- **Subteam & Team Comms Access** — full access to project-specific Drive/Trello/Discord channels and team coordination spaces
- **Leadership Eligibility** — ability to run for exec positions or lead a subteam
- **Website & Public Recognition** — photo and name featured on the GRP website team page
- **GRP Outreach Events** — access to club-hosted outreach and networking events with industry partners
- **Internship Referrals** — consideration for GRP's industry internship referral network

Members who lose AMS retain access to general GRP communication channels (announcements, general body meeting info) but lose the benefits above until AMS is regained.

3 Inactive Member Status

3.1. Members who fail to complete one or more of their AMS requirements are subject to Inactive Memeber Status desingrantion

3.2. Active Member Status is regained by attending 2 consecutive General Body Meetings and the next scheduled In-Person Rocketry Safety Class.

Member Acknowledgment

By signing below, I acknowledge that I have read this document in its entirety and have completed sections 1.1 through 1.8 as outlined above. I also understand that I must complete this document before attending the rocketry training.

Printed Name: _____

UCSB Email: _____

UCSB Perm Number: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Questions regarding requirements should be directed to GRP leadership.